Sentences & Clauses (Set B)

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Simple sentences: Is 'The river flooded the village' a simple sentence? Explain why.

Answer: Yes — it has one main clause (one subject, river, and one verb, flooded) and expresses one complete idea.

Compound sentences: Turn these two simple sentences into one compound sentence: 'The bell rang. The pupils lined up.'

Answer: 'The bell rang, and the pupils lined up.' — two main clauses joined by the coordinating conjunction 'and', each able to stand alone.

Complex sentences: In 'Although it was late, she finished her homework,' identify the main clause and the subordinate clause.

Answer: Main clause: 'she finished her homework' (makes sense alone). Subordinate clause: 'Although it was late' (cannot stand alone — it depends on the main clause).

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Is this a simple sentence? 'The baker opened the shop early.' Explain your answer.
2. Identify the main clause in: 'The dog barked loudly.'
3. Which sentence below is a simple sentence? A) The sun rose, and the birds sang. B) The sun rose. C) When the sun rose, the birds sang. D) The sun rose because it was morning. E) Although it was early, the sun rose.
4. Join these two simple sentences into one compound sentence using 'and': 'The kettle boiled. Mum made tea.'
5. Underline the subordinate clause: 'Because it was raining, we stayed inside.'
6. Underline the main clause: 'Because it was raining, we stayed inside.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are coordinating conjunctions used to build compound sentences? A) and B) because C) but D) although E) or
8. Write one simple sentence about a football match.
9. Which sentence is a compound sentence? A) The lights flickered. B) The lights flickered because the storm hit. C) The lights flickered, and then they went out. D) When the storm hit, the lights flickered. E) The flickering lights were strange.
10. Join these two sentences with 'but' to make a compound sentence: 'He practised every day. He still lost the match.'
11. Identify the subject and the verb in this simple sentence: 'The children cheered.'
12. In 'The train was late, so we missed the start of the film,' which word joins the two main clauses? A) was B) late C) so D) missed E) start
13. Write a compound sentence of your own using the conjunction 'or'.
14. Explain why 'Running fast' is NOT a complete sentence.

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15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are complete simple sentences? A) The cat slept. B) Under the table. C) Birds flew south. D) Because it was cold. E) The bell rang.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. In 'When the alarm sounded, everyone left the building calmly,' identify the subordinate clause and the main clause.
2. Which sentence below is a complex sentence? A) The rain stopped, and the sun came out. B) The rain stopped. C) Although the rain stopped, the ground stayed wet. D) The rain stopped; the sun came out. E) The rain and the wind stopped.
3. Combine these two sentences into a complex sentence using 'although': 'She was tired. She finished the race.'
4. Identify the subordinating conjunction in: 'Since the museum closed early, we went to the park instead.'
5. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause, using an example of your own.
6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences are complex sentences? A) If it rains, the match will be cancelled. B) It rained, and the match was cancelled. C) The match was cancelled because it rained. D) It rained heavily all afternoon. E) Although it rained, the match continued.
7. Rewrite 'The wind howled. The waves crashed.' as one compound sentence using a semicolon instead of a conjunction.
8. Which word begins the subordinate clause in 'Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus'? A) Unless B) you C) hurry D) will E) miss
9. Explain why 'After the show finished' is a subordinate clause and not a complete sentence on its own.
10. Write a complex sentence that starts with the subordinating conjunction 'Because'.
11. Identify the two main clauses in this compound sentence: 'The chef prepared the meal, and the waiter served it.'
12. Which sentence correctly uses a comma after a fronted subordinate clause? A) When the bell rang the pupils stood up. B) When the bell rang, the pupils stood up. C) When, the bell rang the pupils stood up. D) When the bell, rang the pupils stood up. E) When the bell rang the, pupils stood up.
13. Turn this simple sentence into a complex sentence by adding a subordinate clause beginning with 'while': 'Dad cooked dinner.'
14. Explain why 'The dog that chased the ball was exhausted' is a complex sentence, identifying the main and subordinate clauses.
15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words can begin a subordinate clause? A) because B) and C) although D) but E) if

Red — Challenge (15 questions)

1. Identify the main clause in "Since the museum closed early, we went to the park instead."
2. Identify the subordinate clause in "Since the museum closed early, we went to the park instead."
3. Which sentence below is complex? A) The fog lifted, and the sun shone. B) The fog lifted. C) Although the fog lifted, it stayed cold. D) The fog lifted; the sun shone.
4. Identify the relative clause in "The bridge, which had stood for years, finally collapsed."
5. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences are COMPOUND (two main clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction)? A) The chef prepared the meal. B) The storm passed, and the sun came out. C) Because it rained, the match was delayed. D) She sang, but he danced. E) The dog slept on the rug.

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6. Combine these two simple sentences into one complex sentence using "when": "The alarm sounded. Everyone left the building."

7. Identify the subordinate clause and say what type it is (time, reason or condition) in "Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus."

8. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause, using this example: "Although it was late, she finished her homework."

9. Rewrite this compound sentence as a complex sentence: "The wind howled, so we stayed indoors."

10. Identify the embedded relative clause in "My neighbour, who moved here last spring, is painting her fence."

11. Is this sentence simple, compound or complex? "Having packed her bags, Noor rushed to the station." A) simple B) compound C) complex D) none of these

12. Add a relative clause to this sentence: "The painting was priceless."

13. Which pair of words is the correlative conjunction in "Neither the bus nor the train was running on time"? A) Neither…nor B) the…the C) bus…train D) running…time

14. Which sentence below is punctuated correctly as a compound sentence joined by a semicolon? A) The crowd cheered; the players bowed. B) The crowd cheered, the players bowed. C) The crowd cheered: the players bowed. D) The crowd cheered the players bowed.

15. Rewrite as one sentence using a semicolon instead of a conjunction: "The thunder rumbled. The lights flickered."

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